

IT IS TIME FOR HOPE

TEXT: Psalm 42:5 *“Why are you cast down, O my inner self? And why should you moan over me and be disquieted within me? Hope in God and wait expectantly for Him, for I shall yet praise Him, Who is the help of my sad countenance, and my God.”*

INTRO: Interestingly enough, this verse is repeated word for word again in Psalm 42:11 and also in Psalm 42:5! Obviously David was struggling with his inner thoughts - Notice what he says: *“Why are you cast down, O my inner self? And why should you moan over me and be disquieted within me? Hope in God and wait expectantly for Him, for I shall yet praise Him, Who is the help of my sad countenance, and my God.”*

We are three-part beings:

- Body... (Earth suit)

- Spirit... (That part of us that is capable of knowing God)
- Soul... (Mind, will, and emotions)

Here in Psalm 42:5 the Psalmist is talking to His soul - his mind, his will, and emotions. He asks his soul, “*Why are you disquieted within me?*” The word “*Disquieted*” means, “*internally raging.*” David was having issues bringing his soulish nature into subjection to his spirit and it played out in the form of an internal rage.

Have we ever had events that caused “*internal raging*” in our lives?

- The loss of a loved one...
- The failure of a marriage...
- A financial reversal...
- Termination of a job...
- Rejection by friends or family...

There are many things that can contribute to internal raging. The question becomes, how to deal with the onset of such emotions.

Once we identify the reason for our internal raging, the next step is what to do about it. David gives the answer to the cure for “*Internal raging*” when he states, “***Hope in God and wait expectantly for Him, for I shall yet praise Him, Who is the help of my sad countenance, and my God.***”

Hope is not a chance or a circumstance. Hope is a person. Hope has a Name. His name is Jesus. When we are not sure of God’s plan or His will for our circumstance, or we are not sure how a situation is going to turn out, we should begin to declare our hope in the Lord! The following declarations are sure to begin the process of replacing “*internal raging*” with hope:

- I will trust in HIS timing...
- I will rely on HIS promises...
- I will wait for HIS answers...
- I will believe in HIS miracles...
- I will rejoice in HIS goodness...
- I will relax in HIS presence...

CONCLUSION:

We can choose today whether we are going to allow the internal raging, or operate in hope!

“Hope in God and wait expectantly for Him, for I shall yet praise Him, Who is the help of my sad countenance, and my God.”

If we believe it is time for hope we must do three things:

- Place our hope in God...
- Wait expectantly for God... (Going to the window looking out – Checking our watch for the time – Pacing the floor - Etc...)
- Praise the one who turns our sad faces into joyful countenances... (If we are hopeful we should notify our faces – The joy of the Lord is our strength – We think ourselves happy – Our joy comes from the Lord, it is not derived from our circumstances)